



Figure 25: Applications manager



Figure 26: Apps are divided into categories

manually. However, even after that the problem remained. The solution was to disable the three Nokia repos and enable them again. This made them work. A weird sort of a bug I'd say.

The packages are listed under different categories (network, multimedia, graphics, etc) which makes it easier to find apps. You can also search apps by their names or even description. I installed AbiWord, SSH client and server, gPodder podcast manager, a few games like SuperTux, and a few more to check them out, and they all worked fine.

In fact, when I read that the KOffice viewer (aka FreeOffice) alpha version was also released [www.kdedevelopers.org/node/4143], I couldn't wait but add the Maemo Extras-Devel repo and try it out. Although it's not recommended to install apps from this repo, don't we do it all the time on our desktops anyway? Besides, if something goes wrong, we can always flash the device because even that's so easy. By the way, this repo has lots of additional apps, so I highly recommend it.

Overall, you might not find as many apps for N900 as you would for an Android phone. But then, there are enough, and more will be on their way as users join the community and help out in porting apps. Besides, now that the OVI Store for Maemo has also gone live, I'm sure commercial software writers will also take notice.

By the way, you can also launch the X Term and install packages the *apt-get* way. You'll need to install the *rootsh* package. This helps you *su* to root (by running the *root* command), and you'll know what to do next. However, according to reports, by default, you can't install Deb files using *dpkg*. For that you'd have to take the "Red Pill". Read more here: <http://nokiaadict.com/2009/12/17/install-deb-files-on-the-n900-take-the-red-pill>.

Isn't it amazing when a mobile device gives you so much control? And this is all legal. No more do you need to google for "How to jailbreak N900" and stuff like that.

X-term and file system

Well, the long-time users swear by the shell, and the N900 comes with a busybox shell out of the box. You can SSH to other computer from the N900, or vice versa (Figure 28). Could things have been any easier? And, switching to root is

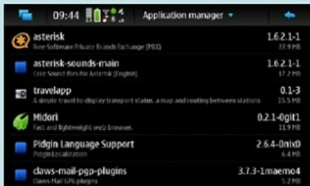


Figure 27: Peeking inside the 'Network' packages category



Figure 28: SSHing to my laptop



Figure 29: What's under N900's / (root file system)